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Gravitational Anomalies

A *gravitational anomaly* is something about gravity that doesn't fit our understanding of the universe, or our understanding of the physical laws that control the universe—for example the falling books, in *Interstellar*, that Murph attributes to a ghost.

Since 1850, physicists have put a lot of effort into searching for gravitational anomalies and understanding those few that were found. Why? Because any true anomaly is likely to produce a scientific revolution; a major change in what we think is True Ⓣ. This, in fact, has happened three times since 1850.

In *Interstellar*, Professor Brand's struggle to understand gravitational anomalies is very much in the spirit of these previous revolutions; so I describe the previous ones, briefly.

The Anomalous Precession of Mercury's Orbit

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